ALBERTO WATCH COMPANY

Design Guide

Single-Page Application & Responsive Website

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Supervisor.	MUHAMMAD ARQUM TARIQ	
Batch.	2606F3	
Group.	E	
Serial No.	Enrollment Number	Student Name
1.	Student1732994	SYED JRAR HASSAN RIZVI .
2.	Student1732990	SHAHEER ALI .
3.	Student1733006	MUHAMMAD AZAAN .

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1. Introduction

1.1 Purpose of this document

This Design Guide describes the visual and interaction design of the Alberto Watch Company website. It records every design decision taken in the project: the page structure, colour palette, typography, layout grid, components, animations and responsive behaviour, so that the site can be reviewed, maintained and extended consistently.

It is the first of three project documents. The **Developer Guide** covers code and setup, and the **User Guide** covers how visitors use the website.

1.2 About the project

Alberto Watch Company is a full-service watch repair, appraisal and retail store offering a wide selection of luxury timepieces, together with brand-new watches from Michael Kors, Rolex, Citizen Eco-Drive, Bulova and others. The website is a Single-Page Application (SPA) that presents the company, its product line-ups, prices, technology, stores and support information in a responsive, visually appealing layout.

1.3 Technology stack

Layer	Technology	Role in the design
Structure	HTML5	Semantic markup; one index.html holding all pages as sections
Styling	CSS3 + Bootstrap 5.3	Grid, components and a custom emerald and gold theme (css/style.css)
Behaviour	JavaScript + jQuery 3.7	Page switching with fade effects, popups, filters, ticker, counter
Fonts	Google Fonts	Playfair Display (headings) and Poppins (body)
Imagery	Inline SVG	Watch illustrations and logo generated in code, no raster images

2. Design Principles

The design follows five principles, chosen to match a premium watch retailer.

- **Luxury and heritage.** Deep emerald and gold evoke fine craftsmanship. Serif headings add a classic, editorial feel.
- **Clarity.** Generous white space, a single clear call to action per area and a consistent card pattern keep browsing simple.
- **Consistency.** Every page uses the same title style, section spacing, card style and button style.
- **Responsive by default.** Layouts are built mobile-first on the Bootstrap grid and adapt from phones to wide desktops.
- **Subtle motion.** Fades, small lifts and a floating hero watch add polish without distracting from the products.

3. Site Architecture

3.1 Single-Page Application model

The whole website lives in one HTML file. Each page is a <section class="page"> that is hidden by default. When a visitor chooses a menu item, the current page fades out, the chosen page fades in and the URL hash changes (for example #products). Because hashes are used, the browser Back and Forward buttons and bookmarks work as expected.

3.2 Page inventory

Page	Hash	In main menu	Purpose
Home	#home	Yes	Hero banner, product line-up cards, company statistics
Products	#products	Yes	Watches grouped by line-up with detail popup
Price List	#pricelist	Yes	Searchable, filterable table of all prices
Technology	#technology	Yes	Explains movements and features used in the watches
Store Locator	#stores	Yes	Store cards with city filter
Support	#support	Yes	FAQ accordion and support contact card
Gallery	#gallery	Yes and footer	Image grid with lightbox

Page	Hash	In main menu	Purpose
About Us	#about	Yes and footer	Company story and contact details
Contact Us	#contact	Yes and footer	Contact details and enquiry form
Site Map	#sitemap	Footer only	Index of every page and product line-up

3.3 Navigation flow

- The **logo** always returns to Home.
- The **main menu** reaches the nine primary pages.
- On Home, each **line-up card** opens Products with that line-up selected.
- On Products and Price List, **View Details** opens a popup without leaving the page.
- The **footer** repeats Site Map, Gallery, About Us and Contact Us.
- The **Site Map** page links to every page and to each product line-up.

3.4 Page frame

Every page shares the same frame, from top to bottom:

Zone	Behaviour	Content
Header	Sticky at the top while scrolling	Logo and company name (left), visitor counter (top right), main menu bar
Page area	Swaps with fade effect	The active page section
Footer	Normal flow at the end of the page	Address, email, phone, secondary links, copyright
Ticker	Fixed to the bottom of the window	Scrolling date, time and location message

4. Colour Palette

The palette is built around **emerald green** for authority and depth and **gold** for luxury accents, on a warm **cream** page background. All colours are defined once as CSS variables in :root and reused everywhere.

Swatch	Name	Hex	Where it is used
	Emerald	#0B3D2E	Main brand colour: navigation bar, section titles, table header, modal header, statistics band, hover-state buttons
	Emerald Dark	#072A20	Site header, footer, ticker, hero gradient start
	Emerald Light	#146B4F	Hero gradient end, secondary headings, links
	Gold	#C9A24B	Accent: primary buttons, brand name, borders, active menu item, underline accents, prices highlight
	Gold Light	#F5E6B8	Menu hover background, tab hover, accordion open state, table row hover, soft text on dark
	Cream	#FAF6EA	Page background and alternate surfaces
	Ink	#1B1B1B	Body text
	Card Border	#EADFC1	One-pixel border around cards

4.1 Colour usage rules

- Use gold sparingly, for emphasis and interactive highlights only.
- Text on emerald backgrounds must be gold, gold light or white. Never use dark text on emerald.
- Body text stays near-black on cream or white for readability.
- Secondary text (descriptions, captions) uses mid-grey values between #555555 and #666666.
- Do not introduce new colours. Add them to the CSS variables first if a new shade is truly needed.

4.2 Menu colour states

State	Text colour	Background	Extra
Normal	#E9EFE9 (off-white)	Emerald	None
Hover	Emerald Dark	Gold Light	Gold underline grows from the centre to full width
Active (clicked / current page)	Emerald Dark	Gold	Remains until another page is chosen

5. Typography

Two Google fonts are paired. **Playfair Display** is a high-contrast serif used for headings and brand elements. **Poppins** is a clean geometric sans-serif used for body text, menus, buttons and forms. Fallbacks are Georgia and Arial.

Element	Font	Size	Weight	Colour
Hero title	Playfair Display	2.4 to 4 rem (fluid)	Bold	White, with gold highlight word
Brand name	Playfair Display	1.7 rem (1.35 on phones)	Bold	Gold
Brand subtitle	Poppins	0.7 rem, letter-spaced, uppercase	Regular	Gold Light
Section title	Playfair Display	Bootstrap h2	Bold	Emerald, gold underline bar
Section subtitle	Poppins	Body size	Regular	Grey #5B5B5B
Card heading	Playfair Display	1.05 to 1.25 rem	Regular	Emerald
Brand tag on card	Poppins	0.75 rem, uppercase	Semi-bold	Gold
Menu link	Poppins	0.92 rem	Medium	Off-white
Body text	Poppins	1 rem	Regular	Ink
Statistic number	Playfair Display	2.6 rem	Bold	Gold
Ticker	Poppins	0.9 rem	Regular	Gold Light

Element	Font	Size	Weight	Colour
Price in popup	Playfair Display	1.8 rem	Regular	Emerald

6. Layout and Spacing

6.1 Grid

The site uses the Bootstrap 12-column grid inside a centred .container. Content blocks are laid out with .row and responsive column classes, with a gutter of 1.5 rem (g-4) for card grids and 1 rem (g-3) for the gallery.

Block	Phone	Tablet	Desktop
Home line-up cards	1 per row	2 per row	3 per row
Product cards	1 per row	2 per row	4 per row
Technology cards	1 per row	2 per row	3 per row
Store cards	1 per row	2 per row	3 per row
Gallery images	2 per row	3 per row	4 per row
Home statistics	2 per row	2 per row	4 per row
Hero	Stacked, text then watch	Stacked	Two columns, text left, watch right

6.2 Spacing and shape

Item	Value
Page section padding (top and bottom)	56 px on desktop, 36 px on phones
Card inner padding	20 to 26 px
Card corner radius	14 px
Card border	1 px solid Card Border colour
Hero padding	70 px vertical (40 px below 992 px)
Section title underline	70 px wide, 3 px tall, gold, centred
Tab pills	Fully rounded (30 px radius), gold outline

6.3 Layering

Layer	z-index
Site header (sticky)	1030
Ticker (fixed)	1040
Modal popups	Bootstrap default (above header and ticker)

The page body has bottom padding equal to the ticker height (38 px) so the footer is never hidden behind the ticker.

7. Header and Navigation

7.1 Header

- **Logo** (circular emerald badge with gold ring and clock hands) beside the stacked text "Alberto" and "WATCH COMPANY".
- **Visitor counter** in the top-right corner beside the logo: a small gold-outlined box with the label "Visitors" and the number below it.
- The header is sticky so the logo, counter and menu stay visible during scrolling.

7.2 Main menu

- Items: Home, Products, Price List, Technology, Store Locator, Support, Gallery, About Us, Contact Us.
- Centred on desktop. On screens below 992 px the menu collapses into a hamburger button with a gold outline, and opens as a vertical list.
- Choosing an item closes the mobile menu automatically.
- Hover and active colours are described in section 4.2. The colour change is animated over 0.3 seconds.
- Page change uses fade-out then fade-in (see section 11).

8. Page Designs

Each page below is listed from top to bottom with its layout. All pages use the shared section title and subtitle style unless stated.

8.1 Home

Section	Content	Layout
Hero	Eyebrow text "Repair, Appraisal, Retail"; headline "Time, perfected."; company description; buttons Shop Collections (gold) and Find a Store (outline); large floating watch illustration	Emerald diagonal gradient background; two columns on desktop
Product line-ups	One card per line-up with watch illustration, name and tagline	3 columns on desktop; whole card clickable
Statistics band	25+ years, 20 featured timepieces, 5 store locations, 2-year warranty	Emerald band, gold numbers, 4 columns

8.2 Products

- Pill tabs for the five line-ups: Vintage, Luxury, Smart Watches, Sports and Clocks. The active tab is filled emerald with gold text.
- A tagline for the chosen line-up appears under the title.
- Product cards show the watch illustration, brand tag, model name, price and a **View Details** button.
- Switching tabs fades the product grid in. Four products are listed per line-up.

8.3 Product detail popup

A centred large Bootstrap modal. The header is emerald with a gold title and gold bottom border. The body has two columns: the product illustration on the left, and on the right a gold line-up badge, description, specification table (brand, movement, size, strap or finish, water resistance) and the price in large serif type. The footer has **Find in Store** (outline) and **Close** (gold) buttons.

8.4 Price List

- A search box (brand or model) and a line-up dropdown sit above the table.
- Table columns: number, brand, model, line-up, price (right-aligned) and a Details button.
- Header row is emerald with gold text. Rows highlight in Gold Light on hover.
- A "No watches match your search" message appears when filters return nothing.
- The table scrolls horizontally on small screens instead of breaking the layout.

8.5 Technology

Six cards in a grid, each with an emoji icon, a serif heading and a short explanation: Automatic Movement, Quartz Precision, Eco-Drive Solar, Sapphire Crystal, Water Resistance and Smart Connectivity.

8.6 Store Locator

A centred city dropdown filters the store cards. Each card has a thick gold left border, the store name, address, phone number and opening hours. The grid fades in whenever the filter changes.

8.7 Support

Two columns on desktop. The left side (two-thirds) holds a Bootstrap accordion with five FAQs; the first is open by default and the open item is highlighted in Gold Light. The right side holds a card with support email, phone and a Contact Us button.

8.8 Gallery

A grid of all 20 watch illustrations on white cards with captions. On hover the card lifts and the image zooms slightly. Clicking an image opens it larger in a modal with the product name as title.

8.9 About Us

Left column: company description and a gold-diamond bullet list of services (repair and restoration, certified appraisals, new, vintage and smart watches). Right column: a Company Details card with email, address and contact number.

8.10 Contact Us

Left column: a details card with email, address, phone and opening hours. Right column: an enquiry form with Name, Email, Subject (dropdown) and Message. Invalid fields show red Bootstrap feedback text; focus rings are gold. After a valid submission the form resets and a green confirmation message fades in and out.

8.11 Site Map

Three cards: Main (Home, Products, Price List, Technology), Product Line-ups (each of the five line-ups, opening Products with that tab selected) and Company (Store Locator, Support, Gallery, About Us, Contact Us).

9. Component Library

Component	Appearance	Hover / focus behaviour
Primary button (btn-gold)	Gold fill, emerald-dark text, semi-bold	Turns emerald with gold text; border stays gold
Outline button (btn-outline-gold)	Transparent, gold border and text	Fills gold with emerald-dark text
Card	White, 14 px radius, 1 px cream-gold border	Lifts 6 px and gains a soft emerald shadow
Line-up tab pill	Gold outline, emerald text, fully rounded	Gold Light fill; active is emerald with gold text
Price table	Emerald header, white and cream rows	Row highlights Gold Light
Accordion	Bootstrap accordion	Open item Gold Light with emerald-dark text; gold focus ring
Form field	Bootstrap form control	Gold border and soft gold ring on focus
Modal	Emerald header with gold title and border, white body	Fades in and out (Bootstrap)
Badge (badge-gold)	Gold fill, emerald-dark text	Not interactive
Visitor counter	Gold-outline rounded box on dark header	Not interactive
Footer	Emerald Dark background, light text, gold links	Link colour changes to gold

10. Imagery and Icons

10.1 Logo

The logo (images/logo.svg) is a circular badge: emerald disc, gold outer ring, dotted inner gold ring, a cream hour hand, a gold minute hand and a gold centre pin, with the letter "A" below. It is used in the header and as the browser tab icon (favicon). Minimum display size is 42 px.

10.2 Watch illustrations

All product images are vector illustrations generated in JavaScript from each product's own colours (dial, case metal and strap). This keeps the site light, sharp at every size and free of image licensing issues. Five illustration styles are used, one per line-up:

Line-up	Illustration style
Vintage	Round case, cream dial, Roman-style numerals at 12, 3, 6 and 9, leather strap
Luxury	Round case, fine minute ticks, date window with magnifier, metal bracelet or strap
Smart Watches	Rounded-square case with a digital screen showing time and heart rate, plus a progress bar
Sports	Round case with three chronograph sub-dials and bold minute ticks
Clocks	Large round clock face with all twelve numerals on a wooden or metal base

All illustrations show the hands at 10:09, the classic watch-advert position, which frames the logo or brand text symmetrically.

10.3 Icons

Technology cards use emoji icons at 2 rem. The menu toggle uses the standard Bootstrap hamburger icon. No icon font is loaded.

11. Animation and Interaction

Effect	Where	Duration	Trigger
Page fade out, then fade in	Switching between pages	200 ms out, 350 ms in	Menu or link click
Colour transition	Menu links, buttons, tabs	0.3 s	Hover
Underline grow	Menu link bottom bar	0.3 s	Hover
Card lift (up 6 px) with shadow	All cards	0.3 s	Hover
Image zoom (1.08)	Gallery images	0.4 s	Hover
Floating motion (12 px)	Hero watch	5 s loop	Automatic
Grid fade in	Product and store grids	350 ms	Tab or filter change
Ticker scroll	Bottom ticker	28 s per pass, linear, endless	Automatic; pauses on hover

Effect	Where	Duration	Trigger
Message fade in / out	Contact confirmation	300 ms in, 6 s shown, 400 ms out	Form submitted
Modal fade	Product and gallery popups	Bootstrap default	Button or image click

Reduced motion: when a visitor's system requests reduced motion, the hero floating animation and the ticker scrolling are switched off and the ticker text is shown static.

12. Responsive Design

Breakpoint	Width	Layout behaviour
Extra small (phones)	Below 576 px	Single-column cards (gallery 2 per row); smaller brand text and logo (42 px); section padding reduced to 36 px; compact visitor box
Small	576 to 767 px	Two-column card grids
Medium (tablets)	768 to 991 px	Two or three columns; menu still collapsed; hero stacked
Large (desktops)	992 px and above	Full horizontal menu; hero in two columns; three or four column grids
Extra large	1200 px and above	Container widens, grids unchanged

Text sizes in the hero use fluid scaling (clamp) so the headline shrinks smoothly. Wide tables scroll horizontally inside their container. Touch targets (menu links, buttons) are at least 38 px tall.

13. Feature Design

13.1 Visitor counter

A box in the top-right corner of the header shows the number of visits. It starts from 1,000 and increases by one the first time a visitor opens the site in a browser session. The value is stored in the browser, so it counts visits made from that browser only. The number is formatted with thousand separators and uses tabular figures so digits do not jump.

13.2 Scrolling ticker

A fixed 38 px bar at the bottom of the window with an emerald-dark background and a gold top border. The text scrolls continuously from right to left and reads:

"Welcome to Alberto Watch Company | Date: (full date) | Time: (live clock) | Location: (latitude and longitude)"

The time updates every second. Location comes from the HTML5 Geolocation API. If the visitor refuses permission, or the browser does not support it, the ticker shows "Location access denied", "Location unavailable" or "Geolocation not supported" instead. Hovering over the ticker pauses it.

13.3 Product detail popup

Triggered from the product cards and the price list. The popup is filled from the product data, so adding a product never requires new markup.

13.4 Filtering

Price List filtering happens instantly as the visitor types or changes the dropdown. Store filtering and line-up switching re-render the grid with a short fade.

14. Accessibility and Browser Support

14.1 Accessibility

- Text and background pairs (ink on cream, gold on emerald) keep strong contrast.
- Illustrations carry an accessible label with the product name.
- Cards that act as buttons (line-up cards, gallery images) can be focused with the keyboard and activated with Enter.
- Form fields have labels and visible error messages.
- The menu toggle has an accessible label.
- Motion can be reduced through the operating system setting.

14.2 Browser support

The site is designed for current versions of Chrome, Firefox, Edge and Safari. Bootstrap 5 does not support Internet Explorer, so IE is outside the supported set. Geolocation requires a secure context (HTTPS or localhost) in most browsers.

15. Project File Structure

```
alberto-watch/
  index.html          All pages, popups, header, footer, ticker
  css/
    style.css         Theme variables and custom styling
  js/
    data.js           Products, line-ups, stores, FAQ, technology
    main.js           Navigation, rendering, popups, filters, ticker
  images/
    logo.svg          Company logo and favicon
```

External libraries (Bootstrap 5.3.3, jQuery 3.7.1 and Google Fonts) are loaded from CDNs.

16. Requirement Traceability

This table links each requirement in the project specification to the design element that satisfies it.

Requirement	Design solution
Single-Page Application	One HTML file; sections swapped with fade and hash routing (section 3)
Responsive layout	Bootstrap grid and breakpoints (sections 6 and 12)
Suitable logo and decent colour combination	Emerald, gold and cream palette; SVG logo (sections 4 and 10)
Menu with Products, Technology, Store Locator, Support	Main menu bar (section 7.2)
Sections for different watches, clocks and technology	Products and Technology pages (sections 8.2 and 8.5)
Product line-ups such as Vintage, Luxury, Smart	Five line-up tabs (section 8.2)
Complete list shown when a line-up is selected	Product grid for the chosen line-up (section 8.2)
Details displayed in a popup window	Product detail modal (section 8.3)
Price list for all watches	Price List page (section 8.4)
Gallery of images	Gallery page with lightbox (section 8.8)
Site map, Gallery, About Us, Contact Us links	Footer links and Site Map page (sections 3.3 and 8.11)
About and Contact show email, address, phone	About and Contact pages (sections 8.9 and 8.10)
Scrolling ticker with date, time, location	Bottom ticker with Geolocation (section 13.2)
Visitor count at top right beside logo	Header visitor counter (sections 7.1 and 13.1)
Menu changes colour on hover and after click	Hover and active states (section 4.2)
Fade in and fade out for menus	Page transitions (section 11)